

DSAII- HW3

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Februrary 16, 2026

Problem 1

Prove there is always a starting post that ensures the cat will win. Prove by Induction on n for $n \geq 1$.

BC: There are 2 posts, $n = 1$. In this case there is 1 Red and 1 Black post.

In the case the cat starts on the Red post, then trivially, it has visited at least 0 red posts ($1 \text{ Red} \geq 0 \text{ Black}$). Then when the cat goes to the black post, the cat wins since $1 \text{ Red} \geq 1 \text{ Black}$. Thus when the cat starts on red the base case is always True.

IH: The can can always win in the case where the input has at most $2(n - 1)$ posts. (From Problem Statement)

IS:

If there are $2n$ posts then there must be a pair of Red and Black posts that is adjacent. If we remove these 3 posts there are $2(n - 1)$ total posts with there being $(n - 1)$ Red and $(n - 1)$ Black. By the IH, this pattern must have Winning starting position.

If the smaller pattern has a winning start, then the 2 posts we took away earlier doesn't effect the Smaller pattern since the base case is True, thus there is always a winning position.

Problem 2

Prove by Induction that any fully parenthesized product of Matrices has exactly $n - 1$ pairs of parentheses.

BC: In the case that we have a single product of matrices, $n = 2$. Trivially, this satisfies the proof that there are exactly $n - 1$ pairs of parentheses, thus True.

IH: For any fully parenthesized product of k matrices, where $k < n$ there are exactly $k - 1$ pairs of parentheses.

IS: In this case we must have $n > 2$ matrices. For the product of n matrices we have the format (AB) where A is the product of i matrices for some $1 \leq i < n$ and B is the product of j matrices where $j = n - i$. This the total amount of matrices being multiplies is $n = i + j$.

By the IH, A must have $i - 1$ parentheses and B must have $j - 1$ parentheses. When counting the total amount of parentheses for the entire product, P we get $P = (i - 1) + (j - 1) + 1$.

The 1 is for the pair that wraps (AB), thus $P = i + j - 1 = n - 1$, so this is true.

Problem 3

Part A

For the algorithm, we need to 1st find a Knight. If a knight always tells the truth, we can identify all the others using the knight. Once we have the knight, we only need $n - 1$ questions to identify the others.

```

findKnight(people)
    if len(people) = 1
        return people[0] //Must be the knight
    winners = [] //Now pair up N people
    for each pair (A,B):
        Ask A: "what is B's type"
        if A answers "B is a knight"
            add B to winners
        else
            Discard Both A and B

    return findKnight(winners) //recursively search through possible knight

```

In this structure there are 4 cases when we ask about the other in the pair.

1. If A is a knight and answers B is a knight, B is a knight so we keep B.
2. If A is a knight and answers B is a knave, we discard both.
3. If A is a knave and answers B is a knight, B is unknown but we keep them and we discard A.
4. A is a knave and answers B is a knave, We lose both and B's identity doesn't matter.

We only know we loose a Knight in Case 2, where we also loose a Knave, since we started with majority knights, this is maintained.

Once we have the knights for certain, we can identify the rest with the knight.

Part B

Claim: If at most $\frac{n}{2}$ people are knights, it is impossible to determine everybody's type. Thus, the number of knight must be $n \leq \frac{n}{2}$.

Proof by Counter Example

Suppose we have 4 people, 2 knights and 2 knaves. We will call the Knight A and B and the knaves C and D .

Knights = A, B

Knaves = C, D

If the knaves always tell the truth, we cannot identify anybody since because at least 2 of the answers are uncertain, we cannot identify anybody.

On the contrary if there is only 1 knave and 3 knights (majority knight), The knave's response doesn't matter since there are 3 consistent answers that identify the knave. So there must be majority knights to identify everybody.

Problem 4

Part A

For the recurrence relation, The initial Base Case is that the red ball starts in the the 1st bin (left), so $p(1) = 1$. To find the recurrence $p(n + 1)$, we need to find the probability that the red ball is in bin q at the start of the next round. Case 1: The red ball is in bin 1 at the start of round n . For the red to stay in the bin there is a $\frac{3}{4}$ chance.

Case 2: The red ball is in bin 2 (right) at the start of round n . For the red to move back to bin 1 after the swap, we must pick it out from the other bin. This has a $\frac{1}{4}$ chance of happening. This is the same as $1 - p(n)$

So the recurrence relation is $p(n + 1) = p(n) \cdot \frac{3}{4} + (1 - p(n)) \cdot \frac{1}{4}$
Simplifying this we get the recurrence relation $p(n + 1) = \frac{1}{2} \cdot p(n) + \frac{1}{4}$

Part B

To make a good guess we are going to step through n till we see a pattern.

$$p(1) = 1$$

$$p(2) = \frac{1}{2}p(1) + \frac{1}{4} = 3/4$$

$$p(3) = \frac{1}{2}p(2) + \frac{1}{4} = 5/8$$

$$p(4) = \frac{1}{2}p(3) + \frac{1}{4} = 9/16$$

The patterns that emerges is $p(n) = 2^{n-1} + 1/2^n$

Proof by induction on n

BC: $n = 1$. $p(1) = 1$ is given, in our equation, $p(1) = 2^0 + 1/2 = 1$, hence this is correct.

IH: For $n \geq 1$, $p(n) = 2^{n-1} + 1/2^n$

IS: For $n + 1$

$$p(n + 1) = 1/2 \cdot p(n) + 1/4$$

$$p(n + 1) = 1/2(2^{n-1} + 1/2^n) + 1/4$$

$$p(n + 1) = 2^{n-1} + 1/2 \cdot 2^n + 1/4$$

$$p(n + 1) = 2^{n-1} + 1/2^{n+1} + 1/4$$

We can convert $1/4$ to have a common denominator so $1/4 = 2^{n-1}/2^{n+1}$

$$p(n + 1) = 2^{n-1} + 1/2^{n+1} + 2^{n-1}/2^{n+1}$$

$$p(n + 1) = 2^{n-1} + 1 + 2^{n-1}/2^{n+1}$$

$$p(n + 1) = 2 \cdot 2^{n-1} + 1/2^{n+1}$$

$$p(n + 1) = 2^{n+1} + 1/2^n$$

Thus this is correct.

Part C

Let X_i be an indicator variable where $X_i = 1$ if the red ball being in bin 1 at the start of round i , 0 otherwise.

The total number of rounds the ball is expected to be in bin 1 is $X_1 + X_2 + \dots + X_m$.

By LOE we can get the expectation

$$E[X_1 + X_2 + \dots + X_m] = E[X_1] + E[X_2] + \dots + E[X_m]$$

$$\sum_{i=1}^m X_i$$

X_i is the same as our result from part b, so $X_i = 2^{n-1} + 1/2^n$

$$\sum_{i=1}^m 2^{i-1} + 1/2^i$$

$$\sum_{i=1}^m 2^{i-1}/2^i + \sum_{i=1}^m 1/2^i$$

The 1st sum

$$\sum_{i=1}^m 2^{i-1}/2^i = m/2 \text{ The 2nd sum}$$

$$\sum_{i=1}^m 1/2^i = 1 - 1/2^m$$

Putting the sums back together we get

$$E[\text{Total rounds in Bin 1}] = m/2 + (1 - 1/2^m)$$